

Lahcen Bounader

(Macro) Economist, Middle East & North Africa
World Bank

lahcen.bouna@gmail.com
lbounader@worldbank.org
[+12028486023](tel:+12028486023)

Professional Activities

April 2025-Present: (Macro) Economist, World Bank.

- Led the Systematic Country Diagnostic for Morocco.
- Led Macro Poverty Outlooks and Economic Monitors.
- Contributed to the Public Finance Review, and the Growth and Jobs Report.
- Contributed to designing financing operations: DPO for growth and jobs 2025-27.

Sep. 2018-April 2025: Economist, International Monetary Fund.

- Led macro and structural discussion for Egypt under Extended Fund Facility (EFF 2018-19). Design the follow-up IMF engagement with Egypt in 2020.
- Led fiscal policy design and discussions with Kenyan authorities under the Extended Credit Facility (2020-22).
- Led fiscal policy design and discussions with Jordanian authorities under the EFF (2022-25).
- Led work on fiscal policy issues in the IMF's Fiscal Affairs Department on fiscal policy in the age of automation, debt issues, fiscal risks, SDGs financing, and fiscal-monetary interactions.

Dec 2014-July 2018: Economist, Research Department, Central Bank of Morocco.

- Prepare macro projections.
- Prepare notes for the Management to inform monetary policy decisions.

Education

2016 – 2021. **Ph.D.** Essays in behavioral economics and monetary policy – **Mohammed V University**.
2011 - 2014 **M.Eng.** in Statistics and Applied Economics - **INSEA** (Stats and Economics Engineering Track).
2009 - 2011 **Maths Sup. / Maths Spé.** (Preparatory classes, CPGE) - **Kénitra** (Mathematics and Physics Track).

Research

Articles

1. **The Diagnostic Financial Accelerator**, with S. Elekdag
Forthcoming in The International Journal of Central Banking.
2. **Estimation Behavioral Inattention**, with J. Benchimol and M. Dotta.
Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, August 2025.
3. **Robustly optimal monetary policy in a behavioral environment**, with G. Traficante.
The B.E. Journal of Macroeconomics, De Gruyter, 2022.
4. **Optimal monetary policy under bounded rationality**, with J. Benchimol.
Journal of Financial Stability, 2023.
5. **Book Review of "Bounded rationality: Heuristics, Judgement, and Public Policy"**.
Political Science Quarterly, 2023.

Working papers

1. **The Diagnostic Financial Accelerator**. IMF WP 2024. With S. Elekdag.
2. **Debt Surges—Drivers, Consequences, and Policy Implications**. IMF WP 2024
3. **How can gains from automation benefit all? Fiscal policies to the rescue**. (with A. Berg, N. Gueorguiev, H. Miyamoto, K. Moriyama, R. Nakatani, F. Zanna) IMF WP 2021
4. **Is there a one-size-fits-all approach to inclusive growth? A case study analysis**, (with S. Balasubramanian, J. Bricco, D. Vasilyev)
5. **Firm-level data and monetary policy: the case of a middle-income country**. (with Mohamed Doukali) IMF WP 2019
6. **Present-biased households and monetary policy**. (with Jonathan Benchimol and Doron Kliger)

Book Chapters

1. **Analytical Framework to Incorporate Fiscal Risks into Fiscal Policy Analysis During Crises**. Forthcoming in technical note and manual of the IMF.

2. **Case studies in inclusive growth.** “How to Achieve Inclusive Growth” Oxford University Press.
3. **Medium and long-term view of monetary policy in Egypt.** “The Egyptian Economy” AUC Press.

Seminars and conferences

- American Economic Association (ASSA) 2022.
- Western Economic Association (Virtual). 2021
- Federal Reserve Board, Washington DC, 2019
- Annual Conference of the European Economic Association (Virtual), 2020.
- Federal Reserve Bank of Boston Research Seminar, Boston, USA, November, 2019.
- CEPR Network on Macroeconomic Modelling and Model Comparison (MMCN), 2nd Annual Conference, Stanford, California, USA, June 7-8, 2018.
- International Economic Association World Congress, Santa Fe, Mexico, June, 2017.
- PhD Workshop, Macro Marrakech, Morocco, 2017.
- The 3rd Days of Econometrics for Finance Conference, Rabat, Morocco, 2016.

Certificates

IMF Leadership Series IGNITE PROGRAM with Duke Corporate Education (2022), IMF Strategic Negotiations (2021), Monetary Policy (IMF, Mar. 2017). Macroeconomic Diagnostics (IMF, Oct. 2016). Monetary Policy Analysis (IMF, Dec. 2015). Macroeconomic Forecasting (IMF, Jul. 2015). Financial Programming (IMF, Apr. 2015). Moroccan Mathematical Olympiads (2009).

Teaching

- 2018: Advanced Macro and DSGE models. (PhD level course) **Mohammed V University.**
- 2017: VARs and SVARs models. (Master level course). **Mohammed V University**

Referee

- **Journal of Money Credit and Banking**
- **Review of Development Economics**
- **Journal of Macroeconomics**
- **Economics Bulletin**

Other

Codes replication

- Replication of Gali (2010): Monetary policy and unemployment. The link of the code (in Dynare) developed jointly with Johannes Pfeifer. Link: https://github.com/JohannesPfeifer/DSGE_mod/tree/master/Gali_2010.

Languages

- **French:** Bilingual.
- **English:** Bilingual
- **Arabic:** Native.

Hobbies

Chess, Reading, Classical Piano.

References

- Xavier Gabaix, Harvard University, Economics Department Littauer Center. xgabaix@fas.harvard.edu
- Selim Elekdag, Division Chief, International Monetary Fund. selekdag@imf.org
- Subir Lall, Deputy Director, International Monetary Fund. slall@imf.org